

Attendees

- fancyplanks (Impstation, Aurora's Song)
- akesi pali (Stellar Station)
- Amatadorro (Troyeshina Pirates)
- aquif (Cosmatic Drift)
- Bibble (Jamboree)
- Bird (Starlight)
- Chief_Engineer (Unaffiliated)
- cyberjoel (Afterlight, Frontier, Delta-V, Euphoria)
- Dave (WizDen)
- Errant (WizDen Maintainer)
- Falcon (Aurora's Song)
- Fried (Moffstation)
- Geekyhobo (Former Wizden)
- G (Funkystation)
- Hivehum (Impstation, Macrocosm)
- Jimboe (Delta-V)
- June (The Den)
- Kamila (Starlight)
- Lobsterpaw (Impstation)
- lunarcomets (Cosmatic Drift)
- nikthechampiongr (Unaffiliated)
- Mazziebot (Former Wizden)
- mqole (Impstation, Macrocosm)
- Myzumi (Tools, Independent)
- Nairod (Cosmatic Drift)
- Pox (Aurora's Song)
- Princess (Former Wizden)
- r3d (Starlight)
- Red Mushie (Starlight)
- Ress (Auth)
- Rinary (Starlight)
- Rosie (Aurora's Song)
- ScarKy0 (WizDen)
- Shepard (Delta-V)
- Slam (Former WizDen)
- Tess (Starlight)
- Trosling (Starlight)
- UpAndLeaves (WizDen)
- youtissoum (Harmony)

Slides: 📄 SCC Meeting Agenda 6th of October

Date: Oct 6, 2026

Minutes taken by mqole (493234058088677379)

Meeting chaired by fancyplanks (466566375205502977)

NOTE: Over the course of this meeting several screenshots were shared to provide evidence of interactions described. Those screenshots have not been included in this document for privacy concerns, but instances where they were provided have been noted.

Topics

Wizden staff exodus and context

What happened?

Invite speakers with any relevant context

Mazziebot - Former Downstream Relations for WizDen

Mazzie: speaking as former downstream relations team member for wizden, working alongside hivehum, princess, ezspezy. As of yesterday, mazzie, hive, princess resigned. In response to a vote of no confidence held for game director Jezithyr. The following context is from mazzie's perspective, not aware of other incidents. Conflicts largely started to form from pr & downstream relations teams.

AGPL situation / controversy, staff chat leak by hostile actors in which wizden staff discussed AGPL with lawyers. in this conversation it was improperly handled. Lots of speculation, people drawing conclusions, when the leaks happened it fuelled a mass panic for AGPL downstreams who were disproportionately affected. Total nightmare. Few key people in wizden notable for statements about AGPL; one was jezithyr. Don't remember specific statements, but many were brought up as concerning especially re. removal from steam of AGPL downstreams or dehub. also discussed other actions that could or would be taken if steam or valve took action. Resulted in internal investigation by staff. Timeline: Staff complaint -> Staff Managers (team designed to hold staff accountable) issued infraction to jezithyr regarding this incident. downstreams relations team on edge after this incident.

2 months ago in early august, downstream relations (DR) planned out downstream bridge (bridge). conflict began here. Over time mazzie and hivehum felt a majority of workload was damage control for misinformation or miscommunication presented by jezithyr (opinion presented as fact, etc). when trying to address issues with jezithyr or through staff channels, felt they were not appropriately listened to. The situation worsened over time. Several internal debates and internal instances that led to tensions escalating.

nubody: jezithyr is an outspoken critic of nubody. mazzie does not have an opinion on the code. Jezithyr's opinions were received controversially by bridge members and internally at wizden. hivehum raised concerns about jezithyr saying she wanted to rework nubody. jezithyr responded with the stance that nubody was not popular among downstreams and that the most notable downstreams did not pull nubody because it was bad. bias towards RMC and starlight: rmc operated by girlfriend DrSmugleaf, jezithyr runs a fork of starlight (afterlight). mazzie believes this bias informs actions. Will share some screenshots.

There were several situations once the downstream bridge was opened in which jezithyr was asked through private channels to stop talking about nubody until the team had formally decided on a communication strategy for jezithyr's plans. The original situation started on sep 6 (day bridge opened), mazzie pinged and DMed in the downstream channel to stop talking about nubody. first escalation: jezithyr refused to abide by this advice and continued talking. When the DR team presented staff policy to the team, it was established that mazzie was supposed to be the main moderator of bridge and could step in to handle moderation situations. Mazzie felt it needed to step in here as jezithyr's statements were creating panic. jezithyr claimed that her position as game director superseded DR's position and advice. After a heated exchange (which mazzie declares some fault in, using heated language that jezithyr was reasonably defensive of), jezithyr declared she should be able to talk about game direction without PR oversight.

After intervention there was a period where she stopped talking in DR internal channels but continued talking about nubody in the bridge after repeated requests to stop from hivehum, princess, mazzie: continued 2 days. continued claim that director privileges stand above DR policies. This is incongruent with internal outline doc presenting standards for director policy: "Directors are not above other staff". Image posted in voice chat displaying policy.

trosling: Just a small objection, Jez was never a maintainer on Starlight. They were a developer mostly exclusively working on a Nubody alternative until the PJB debacle ended and she left for WizDen.

mazzie: sharing a screenshot of the current WizDen director code of conduct and policy.

Director Code of Conduct

Project First

A director of the project is expected to make major decisions about the project as part of their role. When making these decisions, whether within their role or as part of a director vote, they should be putting the needs of the project first and their personal desires second. A director should be objective and avoid personal biases when making decisions, promoting staff, and implementing policy. If necessary, they should recuse themselves and allow another trusted staff member if their objectiveness is compromised.

Directors are not above other staff

All directors are subject to the same rules and procedures as those under their explicit jurisdiction. This means a director cannot simply ignore policy because they feel that policy is restricting them or that policy is bad. If a director feels limited by policy, they should instead change that policy to remove those limitations for *all* of their staff.

Responsibility goes both ways

A Director should delegate as much as is reasonable to the staff below them. Their staff should be able to self-direct for the duties assigned to them, including the ability to restructure themselves if needed. A Director should never be burdening themselves with responsibility or bottle-necking other staff's duties for any reason. At the same time, the Director is responsible for the staff below them and ensuring they remain organized and effective in their duties.

Director Policy

Directors are the visionaries and leaders of the project. Their policy is intended to reflect that, with most director power being intended to be used for goal setting and direction rather than executive decision making.

Implication that directors cannot go into other departments and make changes or be an authority in that department without explicit approval from another director. The DR team felt that Jezithyr overstepping the bridge and disregarding requests to stop talking was a violation of policy. When presented with the policy jezithyr said the policy was "included by mistake and should have been removed". policy was written in conjunction with princess, signed off on, and included as director policy on outline. Distrust took a chokehold on DR work at this point.

Jezithyr was later noted to bring up these situations in director chats, complaining about mazzie and hivehum to other directors. Mazzie agrees that in some situations it and hivehum were heated. however repeated pattern of jezithyr disregard for policy should be emphasised.

slam: For the incident regarding numed, I believe the Staff Manager team was provided several staff complaints, which were anonymized and then two Staff Managers reached out and discussed them with her. She was largely dismissive of the complaints.

scar: This is correct. Me and Jedan have reached out to her. Jezi was primarily dismissive and said they're in bad faith

mazzie: 'bad faith' has been used by her frequently to dismiss and deflect criticism

mazzie: Jezithyr also attempted to violate PII policy (personal identifying information), came into DR channel, asked for bridge application status of goobstation. DR declined to provide any information on if they applied or the status of application. Screenshots of this interaction shared. Incident here between Reisama and Jezithyr. Screenshots show jezithyr arguing about her access to PII which she does not have need to know basis for- wizden PII policy is that access to info requires need-to-know basis or required in order to ensure compliance of PII policy. incident reported to Reisama (jezithyr arguing for release of PII without proper reasoning). Screenshot of director channel received from kazne - jezithyr calling for directors meeting about information siloing, citing staff managers (who handle anonymous complaints) and DR speaking privately. mazzie: SM should be allowed to handle staff manager complaints without threat of intervention by staff. mazzie is told (hearsay) that this incident went on as an argument about information siloing and Jezithyr's conduct re. PII.

Princess: will add to this later. Around this point so much shit started happening that it got mixed up. not sure if I participated in this one.

mazzie: The PII incident then escalated to further staff complaints. incident re conduct towards prev staff members and conduct towards mqole re. documentation. mq will speak on this later.

public escalation occurred on sep 30 when jezithyr was discussing nobody in bridge again, downstreams showed concerns about direction and asked for examples/design docs/api changes. jezithyr could not provide these. in front of all envoys and dignitaries jezithyr expressed inappropriate conduct (screenshot). hivehum stepped in, jezithyr responded, mazzie publically stepped in to ask her to stop talking. jezithyr became aggressive, condescending, patronising, declared that it was a design matter and did not fall under PR authority. This made Mazzie tell staff that it wanted to quit. At this time a lot of people did know what was happening as a lot of the avenues taken up to this point were through SM, anonymous, or otherwise. PR only made the decision to escalate after jezithyr was openly aggressive to DR members in the bridge. Large argument within SM office. Kazne, reisama, princess called for emergency removal of jezithyr's permissions until a vote of no confidence.

was NOT when the vote was initially called. The vote was initially called 9/11 (screenshot shared). Under bylaws, vote must be done within a week of request. The vote did not happen until 10/5. should have been completed on 9/18.

realization that director policy, designed to hold directors responsible, did not work- many people independently concluded that if jezithyr could not be held accountable to policy there would be a mass exodus. This was brought up during vote and was presented as an ultimatum, but unlike headmin exodus this was largely unorganised. Several independent parties came to their own independent conclusions without talking to others, only learned that sentiment was shared when things became public.

hivehum: i would say "organized" is a strong word. i think many of us independently came to the conclusion we needed to resign if jezithyr was not held accountable

mazzie: correct, was spontaneous

mazzie: This along with other complaints about jezithyr conduct was presented formally on Oct 6. all data including 20+ staff complaints, downstream statements, statements from staff.

mazzie's statement sent to directors is as follows:

@directors
preface

all of this is a result of my frustrations. i cannot bottle up my struggle anymore. i will not hesitate to use strong language. this means a lot to me, and as i wrote this, i got angrier and angrier from the fact that it has escalated to this point. this entire situation is solely a failure of Wizards' Den management.
you guys fucked up

i try to be a kind person. other people say i'm kind so i think i'm doing an okay job so far. i wasn't always like this; i used to be a really mean and spiteful person. i'm still spiteful, but now i try to be kind out of spite. i don't like getting in conflict and try to avoid it, but at heart i'm confrontational and i fight for what i find to be just or fair. furthermore i've been at the community management thing for quite a while. i've run my own communities and learned from community elders much wiser than me in every single way.

furthermore, i have enjoyed most of my time at wizden. i think it is fulfilling and i get to help a lot of people for a game i'm passionate about. i love talking to all the people i get to meet including wizden staff i work with. when i was poached by princess cheeseballs during the PJB drama i was a bit skeptical of the roles and responsibility i would receive. i heard much about how wizden operated itself and the struggles it was going through. kazne and janet personally warned me that it was going to be rough and i might experience burnout. so far, the burnout hasn't been that bad and i've been able to pick up the slack when necessary, and the enjoyment i've derived from being here conceptually outweighs the negatives.

but where has that burnout come from in the first place? was it daily spam pings from Nazis in Atmosia and beyond? was it being on the receiving end of another wave of harassment in my personal life? was it having to deal with harrowing moderation cases both in and outside of SS14 (as i am staff in other places) where i almost feel like throwing up thinking about it? was it struggles to get things moving internally in times where i felt like we already came to a consensus and it was blocked by a couple minor factor? none of the above. it was entirely Jezithyr and her conduct towards me, hivehum, Princess, and other Wizden staff.

It goes without saying that if Jezithyr is not removed from Director, I and plenty of other staff will leave the project, Wizards' Den's reputation among downstreams and the rest of the community will be irreparably shot and killed, and this project will die.

jezithyr

i, along with many others, had high hopes for Wizden during the restructuring. i tossed out any preconceptions i had of its staff coming from an organization coming from downstreams in favor of that fresh slate. the early periods were rough but that was to be expected. but as things matured, the pain in my back that was Jezithyr reared her head.

from my knowledge, and from my experience, Jezithyr's conduct has been nothing short of bullying and controlling. when i came onto the team i did not expect for the biggest hurdle in my work to be Jezithyr, the Game Director. i don't think i really need to cover everything she did in specifics but i can simply say that the #1 fear i had going forward when i would bring up anything in PR and DSR related channels was Jezithyr coming in to disruptively provide her 2 cents, or almost patronizingly explain to us "considerations" or "consequences" for what we were doing. i'd like to emphasize the patronizing aspect: if these were simply add-ons to the conversation to ensure the discussion process was complete and fruitful, then she would not have insisted on and on that we weren't properly considering when we declared to her "yeah we considered this it's not a problem".

beyond the actual experience with working with Jezithyr, she just doesn't know when to STOP TALKING. a million eyes on her and she just says bullshit that is 1. unconfirmed 2. wrong 3. misrepresentative of the actual position. then that is a job for PR and DSR to handle. i have tried to express this in my complaint because i wanted to handle this without everything exploding. i have also expressed this directly to her in our various conflicts. her role in my work is being the problematic character i have to clean up after. when i lashed out at her in DSR HQ my "a dog with no leash" comment was directed exactly at this: she does shit without any regard for how it affects others or the project.

her controlling behavior is especially important to consider. i can only explain what she does as she believes she's the head of the project. she demands access to PII that she is not in the "need-to-know" for, simply because she believes she should have access to it because she is a Director. then she went on to Director chat to complain about information siloing because she was denied private information, which also includes hub moderation, which is intentionally organized separately for privacy and security

(screenshots here removed)

i'd also like to add her insistence on knowing if Goob applied and her previous comments on Durk indicates heavy bias. speaking of bias, can we talk about how blatantly biased she is towards RMC and Starlight/Afterlight? any time that a conversation came up she had some way to bring up RMC/Starlight and how they have the MOST players as if it isn't clear to everyone that she has vested interest in those servers as RMC is Smug's server and she's a maintainer/downstream host of Starlight? why does this Wizden director not even try to hide that she acts in the interests of a small selection of servers? i

can't stop noticing it every time i look back to conversations about downstreams. she brings up how we're "ignoring downstreams" but uses that as the excuse to argue her point for RMC and Starlight being more important than others.

case in point is the problematic exchange between Jezithyr and mqole about Nubody. or the one with Jezithyr and Hivehum.

(screenshots here removed)

who gives a fuck about RMC?

this persisted all the way to today when i got frankly exhausted of keeping my mouth shut about the abusive behavior i previously demonstrated in my complaints and more. why did actual DSR work happen in a group chat where Jezithyr would not be able to see? because she would constantly disrupt it and it proved more helpful to discuss what we wanted to do in the staff complaint group chat where we felt that we could actually do the shit we need to do without being badgered. with the overstepping of her position into ours, making the Executive Decision:tm: that she is somehow above other departments, and simultaneously making our jobs harder.

her middle-school level talking back in Bridge was the best thing to happen in DSR as of late. people finally get to see the struggle we have been dealing with. i have received nothing but support and sympathy for her bullshit. this is not a fault of anyone else except Jezithyr and the Directors for letting this escalate to this degree.
to directors

how did this even come to this point? did the constant staff complaints do nothing? were the image and reputation considerations not pertinent enough? was Kazne calling for a vote on the 11th not enough to actually do anything? did it seriously take a public escalation for anything to happen? the fact that the vote got delayed since Nine Eleven is harrowing. you have bylaws, right? the point of having these stupid policies and bylaws is to follow them, right? so why did it take almost an entire month to actually start the vote, when it was supposed to be done by the 18th?

this has to go deep. i'm losing faith here. i want to have faith here. but i need a reason to keep it. there was an active abuse case under your noses and it was delay after delay after delay. there was a director actively causing problems in your private chat, so far as to attempt to change the staff complaint system and staff manager department in response to her getting in trouble. WHY DID THIS TAKE SO LONG? all the signs were there and you did NOTHING until it EXPLODED!!!

this is a good lesson in doing shit before it's too late. this was almost too late. you should honestly be grateful that i and others decided to escalate. if

this continued to bottle up more and more, you would've destroyed this project from your inaction.

in the immortal words of Jezithyr, control your staff.

statement ends

hivehum's statement sent to directors is as follows:

Disclosure: this is my own opinion. I have made assertions in this that are my own beliefs. I did not do proper research into the veracity of these claims, many of which are not really possible to prove, but I do believe them.

directors

jezithyr

I will say this upfront: ****if Jezithyr is allowed to remain as Game Director, I am quitting.**** Not only am I quitting, but I will publicly condemn Wizards' Den in every venue I have available to me, explaining that SWF has burnt all faith I have in it to be a trustworthy organization, and I will strongly advocate for every downstream project I am involved in to cut ties with Wizards' Den and hard fork.

This is not a sentiment I share lightly. It is the culmination of months of working with and under Jezithyr. It is a plan I've formed after reading tens of thousands of words of downstream contributors' concerns about her ability to lead. I believe she is unfit for any type of authority position, in this project or any else.

This is an inexhaustive list of my issues with Jezithyr as Game Director.

* I strongly believe that Jezithyr is unable to separate her own personal interests from the wellbeing of the project. I think that she pushes Wizards' Den into situations that do little but to assuage her own past grudges. This includes, but is not limited to:

* The AGPL situation. I do not know the full circumstances of the MIT vs AGPL split in SS14 codebases, as it was before my time, but I do know that Jezithyr was involved. I find her vitriol regarding AGPL-licensed codebases to be abhorrent in any circumstance, but particularly the one I suspect where it is personally motivated. Not only is it abhorrent, but it's caused probably the most damage of anything she has said. SWF has had to front legal fees to follow up on her statements, and even though we have had a legal expert debunk it, ****she still talks poorly of AGPL-licensed servers.**** This is an accusation that has torpedoed Delta-V!

* BodySystem. Offmed was abandoned as a direct result of statements made by WizDen leadership regarding AGPL. Jezithyr immediately took over the medical rework, in a sequence of events disparaging Janet that I think has been sufficiently documented. But what stuck out to me when this started was that

Jezithyr mentioned repeatedly that her girlfriend made BodySystem. This makes me feel like she is reverting Nubody not because of any concerns about its quality, but because Nubody removed code her girlfriend wrote.

* This is more tenuous but I am extremely uncomfortable when she brings up adding revenue streams to wizden IE asking for royalties for servers that hit a certain size/profit threshold. I find this inarguably rent-seeking behavior. I understand fully what it's like to need money: I don't need to go into the personal details of my life, but it's solely from the generosity of others that I have a roof over my head. I think that trying to get paid from your work on SS14, particularly this aforementioned royalties method, is going to poison the well and destroy relationships between Wizden and its downstreams. If a fork makes enough money that you go and tell them you want 10% of their income they are going to send you lowtiergod images.

* When it comes to downstreams, Jezithyr makes it incredibly clear she only cares about and intends to work with the two downstreams she already has a relationship with: Starlight and RMC.

* She obfuscates this bias by bringing up their high player counts. This is a misleading at best metric – RMC is the largest server if you only count English-language communities, and Starlight is arguably slightly smaller than Funky Station, but regardless the difference is so small as to hardly matter. Even if it were true, this disregards that two high pop servers are far, far, far from the majority of where the playerbase resides. Any decision made with all players in mind must consider more than two servers.

* She is extremely misleading when describing the desires and sentiments of downstreams because, again, she only considers Starlight and RMC, and these are two servers that are already largely estranged from the wider downstream ecosystem. When she says that "most downstreams didn't merge nubody", she is talking about Starlight and RMC. Most downstreams did merge nubody. Anyone on the Bridge can tell you that.

* On the rare occasion she's not solely vouching for RMC and Starlight, she's bringing up Goob and her positive relationship with its owner Durk. Goob is ALSO not fondly regarded by the downstream ecosystem, and is very much not representative of the wider community.

* When I first started playing SS14, it was toward the end of Jezithyr's previous tenure as staff. So my introduction to the Wizards' Den development process was a single individual promising the sun and stars as a remake to our middling medical system, flame out, and vanish for years with the project never materializing. I do understand now that there was a lot of context I was missing as an outsider, and I understand that this context was largely why Jezithyr left SS14 development. However, this kind of track record is not the one I want to have on the Game Director, and I'm afraid my initial apprehension both to her election to the position and resuming of her medical rework have only been validated with her... lack of actually producing anything coherent. With Offmed, I had a good grasp on the goals of the project and the intended scope of Medical gameplay. I also saw a developer who took on collaborators, delegated work, and produced tangible, playable code at a regular pace. With Mewmed, I genuinely could not even begin to tell you what the goals are. There is no design document. To my knowledge, all work is on a branch of a fork of a

fork...? But looking at code isn't the same thing as a describing your intent for the project.

* This dovetails into my concern that I just don't think Jezithyr is a very good director. This is a judgement from my years of experience doing project management both in an SS14 context and in a variety of other professional and amateur projects.

* She's terrible at delegation. Because she doesn't really seem to trust anyone, she doesn't allow other people to work on her projects. She also doesn't really seem to allow people the autonomy to work on their own projects. I am concerned that during her tenure as Game Director, the largest game project the game has released was Changeling, something that was approaching completion before she assumed that role.

* She expresses opinions about Space Station 14 and Robust Toolbox that are at best contradictory and at worst worrying about the project's long-term identity. At various times, I've seen her say:

- * She wants RT to be a competitor to Roblox

- * She wants SS14 to be module-based so downstreams are a customizable experience

- * She doesn't like the customizability focus of my project Macrocosm because it causes "design by committee"

- * Players don't care about contributing

- * Contributors are lesser than staff

- * FOSS doesn't mean everyone can contribute

- * We are a unique example among video game development

- * We are just like every other video game developer

* It's obvious that Jezithyr mistreats Mazzie and I. I've received plenty of complaints about her that corroborate this. She is constantly disparaging to public relations in general but I do think she singles me out in particular. I think there are projects I have been involved with that she would not have blinked at were it a different person involved – the trailer immediately comes to mind. I do think she is intentionally trying to start arguments with me. I think this behavior should not be tolerated by any member of staff, much less a Director.

* I don't think she solely mistreats PR, though. I am extremely unhappy at how she talks to DevOps staff. I don't need to relitigate the multiauth incident from last month, but I am going to mention it, and I will also mention that I first noticed she was back from her forced break because she literally leapt into the devops channel to talk over them and suggest a completely unhelpful solution to the problem they were solving.

* I think, fundamentally, Jezithyr does not trust anyone she doesn't personally know. She is constantly talking down to people and questioning their credentials. She is always bringing up that she was involved in one (1) professional game project (a poorly received and quickly forgotten minecraft spinoff) which somehow makes her opinions more correct than everyone else. It reeks of elitism.

* Conversely, if flashing credentials doesn't win the argument, Jezithyr does not hesitate to pull rank. This is completely unacceptable. It's clearly outlined in Director policy that they are beholden to the same standards as

everyone else. She's a team lead. She isn't God. To be honest, the first time she overruled someone not in her department by saying she's Game Director is the moment I went from wanting her to be reprimanded for causing constant PR incidents to the moment I knew she was not fit to be in leadership.

princess

Princess is why I'm still here. I think Princess is an enormous force for good and positive change within Wizden. We owe more to him than we probably can even imagine. If Princess goes somewhere, I'm probably following him. I have no idea how you have the time to code or review anything while doing Director duties and everything else. You rock.

kazne

If Kazne has not brought up our mutual past, I will: Kazne started out in SS14 development on my server, Impstation, as a contributor and eventually maintainer. He left on bad terms after repeated issues with Impstation's non-hierarchical organization and development practices. I was cautiously optimistic to hear he had been brought on as art director for WizDen, because I felt like the best place for him to flex his technical skills and raw work ethic would be a position like Art Director. If anyone is crazy enough to be able to sprite this whole huge game, it's Kazne.

I think my optimism has worked out! I think most of the issues with Respriting was PR and deployment related (I'll disclose here that I avoided most of the respriting PR work because I believed my past with Kazne was a conflict of interest, and that I now think this was a mistake that contributed to its mishandling). I look forward to seeing his continued resprite work.

I don't think we'll ever see eye to eye with each other, but I respect the hell out of him, and I think he's grown a lot in his ability to work with people and handle criticism between his departure from Impstation and appointment here.

veri

Sorry Veri. This is going to be brutally honest.

I think VeritableCalamity is the second biggest threat to the organization. I have concerns that he makes business decisions to benefit himself at the detriment of the project. I don't like when I check in on the business channel and I see Veri say that we can't organize in a specific way because he would have to divest himself as he legally can't be involved in a foreign enterprise. I think in that situation you probably just gotta resign dude.

Broadly I don't think Veri is being malicious about it, though. I think he's a little bit out of touch most of the time, which is whatever. Maybe just not the best fit for the position. Obviously we super owe you for leaping in and doing hero shit during the Schism, I don't want to downplay that!!!

the rest of you :)

Rei: Sorry I keep throwing temper tantrums and quitting the staff MC servers, I think multiplayer MC just isn't for me LMAO but I do feel pretty embarrassed I keep doing that. Not leaving a good impression. Otherwise I don't think I know you very well lol

Emisse: You are nice to chat with, I don't know you very well so I don't have a strong opinion. Mazzie seems to regard you highly which is good enough for me

ElectroSR: Third biggest threat to the organization, because..... I have never seen him around. Absentee director isn't a great look.

the complaint process

I found the process of filing a staff complaint about Jezithyr ultimately pretty frustrating. I don't know if this is necessarily the fault of any individual or just a lot of people making judgement calls that lead to me being unhappy. Generally the process was very opaque in a way that I didn't know if all the complaints I was receiving and forwarding were going anywhere, what was going on, etc. I don't know if there's a real solution here that handles both the privacy of everyone involved and also doesn't have me feeling like I need an exit plan.

working for wizden

DESPITE EVERYTHING, I genuinely love being Public Relations/Downstream Relations. I find it super fulfilling work. It genuinely makes my day when I can hear out people's concerns and nudge the right things together to get them handled. I am SUPER passionate about community organization, and particularly representing the needs of downstreams. I feel like my position now is exactly where I want to be in order to be that kind of advocate.

And it's been unbelievably cool to rub shoulders with WizDen staff. I'm really glad I get to strike up conversation with people I have only known from their pull requests. Genuinely almost every single person I've met through here has been wonderful.

statement ends

mazzie: conclusion to vote- not fully aware of discussion details. The vote failed 3/3. for removal, must pass with supermajority (4/2 minimum). voting parties for: Princess, Reisama, Kazne. against: VeritableCalamity, ElectroSR, EMisse. After the vote, an exodus happened as predicted. directors who voted to remove jezithyr resigned in solidarity.

mazzie saw many members resign, and documented their messages in the downstream bridge. half resigned half didn't. technically resigned, but was stripped of permissions for communicating transparently to downstream bridge. Said many regrettable things in a

regrettable situation- abuse case improperly handled, ignored, dismissed, failed to remove a director who did abuse a position of power.

so far 21 staff members who have either fully left, partially left, or are considering leaving. mazzie asked for messages to be archived. Later veritablecalamity deleted all resignation messages from staff channels. Later when cashew (elected as acting comms lead after some time) stepped in the bridge messages were deleted, mazzie was blocked, permissions removed, timed out for a week.

hivehum, mazzie, princess, and august have a private dm channel to discuss DR happenings. August has also stepped down.

upandleaves: I can't speak, but someone can bring up the circumstances of my off-the-book mute as well (which was only reversed by an off-the-books unmute by a different person :P)

mazzie: upandleaves (position) came in as a neutral party, was trying to recollect all info and pinned a message with summary of situation (staff complaints, vote failed, people leaving). veritablecalamity unpinned the message. when pointed out, upandleaves was timed out from wizden discord for a week and could not moderate discord. intent from wizden to delete all messages and ensure there is as little info as possible on why all staff are leaving.

upandleaves: For the record, they didn't actually delete my messages.

slam: 12 full/intending to, 3 partial, 10 considering leaving. I got muted for a week for merely pointing out Veri unpinned em

hivehum: i feel it necessary to say just how widespread attempts to hold jezithyr accountable was. It was not just Mazzie and I with complaints. i kept discovering more and more context of staff complaints made that i had never heard of and more issues i had no idea about

jimboe: may be jumping ahead. currently drafting a doc that DV intends to sign. going to be a statement regarding what they want to see from wizden. very strict. document shared:

jimboe's document draft:

The above downstreams, as representatives of the SS14 Continuance Commission, is calling for a full removal of Game Director Jezythir. We ask that all resigned staff have their positions of staff and of leadership reinstated, and that these wrongs against the community and the downstreams to be corrected.

Abusive and abrasive behavior should not be tolerated from any level or any position of leadership. If you continue down this road again, as wizden leadership, the above downstreams will seek complete solidarity against you, and shall continue development on our own, without reliance on any remaining Wizden infrastructure.

We ask that you instate a no-tolerance policy on violations that include abrasive and abusive nature, including directors, owners, or any other role that may be listed as "Important". Abuse is not okay in a volunteer organization in any manner, in any position.

draft ends

mazzie: sharing complaint kazne sent, includes kazne's reasons for leaving the project including images. (link shared, password protected, making public version)

kazne's statement sent to directors, excluding screenshots:

This individual should not be in any position of power whatsoever in any community, organization, or business
Her candor is continuously manipulative, disrespectful, and at times outright insulting to both non-peers and peers alike
She uses manipulative language to assert authority positions in fields of specialized knowledge she herself most certainly does not possess in order to shut down/shut out viewpoints she personally disagrees with or sees as objectionable
She abuses her power in a fighting tooth-and-nail-manner to leverage her position to excuse and get away with repetetively blatant overreach
She uses manipulative language to cast antagonism onto whatever opposing party she puts herself in conflict with in order to make her own horrid (and at times reactionary) behaviour more socially excusable
Pardon my language, but this is fucking disgusting and i'm baffled nobody else is seeing this for what it is.
It's barely been a few months and i need only look through the discord for 2 minutes to find unending piles of these behaviour patterns.

statement ends

Mqole - Impstation, Macrocosm

mqole's staff complaint made september 7:

So a lot of my interactions with Jezithyr have been related to working on documentation for SS14, which is something I'm super passionate about (along with many others I know!) and want to work on soon.

In about January I made some casual inquiries as to how feasible it would be to overhaul the Robust Book as information on there is a bit scattered. I was told that WizDen was thinking about moving off mdbook, which is understandable. During the whole PJB debacle I got the opportunity to talk with other members of WizDen about wanting to improve on docs. Princess gave me access to the Outline docs, explained that it was what was currently being used for staff organization, and gave me the go-ahead to start migrating the existing Robust Book docs over. This process was pretty miserable and I quickly found myself disliking Outline. I expressed these grievances with Princess, and he mentioned that they were still looking for a nice user-facing frontend.

Fast forward a few months and no progress has happened on public docs, so I make a few more inquiries in the SS14 discord docs channel. Jezithyr jumps in

to tell me that Outline will be the frontend. When I tried to express my grievances with Outline, Jezithyr completely stonewalled me. Multiple times I brought up an issue I had experienced only for her to respond along the lines of "that's not a problem" - immensely frustrating to read when I was in the middle of looking at the problem with my own eyes. It wasn't until Julian stepped in a few days later that Jezithyr was willing to make any concessions. Eventually, when the channel was merged with the guidebook and wiki channels, I checked in again with Julian. Julian stated that WizDen planned to use mdbook until they found an alternative, to which Jezithyr responded that no, WizDen was going to use Outline.

I once again expressed my grievances with Outline and have since given up on working on Robust Book docs altogether, in no small part due to the frustrations I have had with Jezithyr's refusal to compromise on feedback. She has previously cited getting positive feedback on Outline from other maintainers and contributors in a way that felt like an invalidation of the criticism I was offering. Fellow contributors privately reached out to me to share their own grievances working with Outline, which was awesome, because up until that point I genuinely felt like I was being gaslit into thinking I just was too stupid to use it properly or something.

This pattern of behaviour Jezithyr exhibits of shutting down any and all criticism her work receives by denying the issue exists has continued into her work with BodySystem and Nubody.

For some context, me and several other maintainer groups were extremely frustrated with the rollout of Nubody due to a cataclysmic lack of documentation (which we expressed to upstream numerous times, but nothing ever really came of it) and have been massively set back in our upstream merge process due to having to contend with breaking changes. We generally do not have a positive opinion of how Nubody is documented and distributed. HOWEVER- we all agree that, on a technical level, the quality of the code is very good and the overhaul to the system was badly needed. Working with Nubody on upstream branches has made me begrudgingly appreciate how easy it is to use, even if documentation is still lacking in several areas.

Jezithyr has not been kind to Nubody. She has expressed her intention to, once again, overhaul the system for WizDen due to it breaking implementations of surgery on Starlight, which to my understanding is a fork that she works on.

When me and the other maintainer groups learned that BodySystem would be reworked AGAIN, right after we had just finished making all our species compatible with Nubody, we were apoplectic. I have a memory of telling someone that such a decision would "irreversibly break the trust of almost all downstreams".

Jezithyr cites Starlight, RMC, and GoobStation as the three most-played SS14 forks, and notes that none of them have pulled Nubody from upstream yet due to incompatibility with their original surgery systems. This is a good thing for

her to identify, and I'm glad she is taking them into consideration. However, she has been repeatedly dismissive of forks which DID take Nubody, have smaller maintainer teams, and which will likely be unable to cope with the compounding breaking changes.

I recently had a conversation about this with Jezithyr in the contributors channel, in which she expressed her doubt that Nubody was easier to work with than the old BodySystem. She called the code 'ass', and justified her saying so by implying that the developer (Janet) was passive aggressive in her PRs. I find this extremely unprofessional behaviour on Jezithyr's part, especially with the added context that Janet had recently left WizDen and SS14 dev as a whole thanks in no small part due to the stress she experienced attempting to assist with Delta-V's emergency rebase to MIT, which was in turn initiated partially due to misinformation about the Steam licensing panic which Jezithyr perpetuated. I am not blaming Jezithyr for making Janet leave SS14 - it's an unfortunate set of circumstances. However I believe that Jezithyr's subsequent (public!!!) condemnation of Janet's work is absolutely appalling behaviour from someone in a position of project leadership. During that same conversation she, once again, repeatedly dismissed issues I raised relating to my lived experience.

I love this community, and I do not doubt that Jezithyr is a very technically adept designer and developer. However, every time I try to speak to her about potential issues with her vision, I am forced to abandon the conversation due to how frustrated I become when she continually minimizes my issues and instead talks about how great Starlight or RMC is for the dozenth time. On the receiving end, it sometimes really feels like she doesn't care about my fork and the smaller community we've built there - only the communities which she has a direct hand in. Which is fine if you're the lead on Starlight, but it's not great if you're the game director for the mother of a thousand forks.

I really appreciate a lot of WizDen's staff and love working with them on all things development. I hope that one day I will be able to enjoy working with Jezithyr too. However she has completely soured my interest in working on upstream for the foreseeable future based solely on how dismissive she has been of me and mine. Again, I love this community, but if I have to overcome a brick wall every time I try to contribute then I will just stop contributing.

statement ends

aquif: Her fork is afterlight not starlight

ress: I want to add some additional context here. Outline was used for internal documentation only. It worked for internal documentation. It was really early on discovered that Outline would NOT do the trick for public read only stuff. I've warned Jez about this. Jez has ignored my objective criticism about the topic. And suggested a very heavy handed wiki platform that did not work.

mqole's follow-up complaint made september 12:

This is an amendment to my previous statement, specifically pertaining to my interactions with Jezithyr about the state of SS14 documentation, as since giving the statement I've received some new information. I want to get really specific here, so this statement will include direct messages from discord, too.

In the intervening time between the initial statement and now, I have been working on creating my own docs instance using a different frontend to mdbook, and shared it with some close friends (who have all been very enthusiastic about it). I've made some statements publicly about my decision to work on documentation independent of WizDen, and been specific about the fact that the only reason I'm not collating my own resources with WizDen's docs repo to begin with is because WizDen plans to use Outline for the next incarnation of their user-facing docs.

So I dmed Princess Cheeseballs about my docs on discord (basically just saying hey, I'm doing this, feel free to use anything I put on there for whatever if anyone wants to) and got told that WizDen was not going to use Outline for the next incarnation of their user-facing docs.

I don't think there are words enough to thoroughly express my consternation at learning this.

For almost three months I have been promised repeatedly by Jezithyr that Outline was going to be the de facto frontend for the new engine and content documentation (not just internal documentation), and when I have tried to express my doubts I have been shut down time and time again.

Here are some examples of this:

<https://discord.com/channels/310555209753690112/672642303743098902/1522781420370526419>
<https://discord.com/channels/310555209753690112/672642303743098902/1522781911884238898>
<https://discord.com/channels/310555209753690112/672642303743098902/1522797171445993574>
<https://discord.com/channels/310555209753690112/942862442688548884/1541390758135730206>
<https://discord.com/channels/310555209753690112/942862442688548884/1541392171612115004>

And here is a public-facing statement that I made about my decision to step away from working on WizDen docs based on the misinformation I was fed by Jezithyr:

<https://discord.com/channels/310555209753690112/942862442688548884/1541654472961302629>

(Please note that following my statement, Jezithyr is STILL trying to convince me to use Outline!!!! I really appreciate Nem and Fildrance trying to move the conversation somewhere productive at the very least, but it does feel like they are also operating on the (incorrect???) assumption that Outline is 100% going to be used for public docs.)

So, okay. WizDen isn't in fact going to use Outline for public docs. At this point I've kind of forced myself to detach from the state of WizDen docs so much that hearing this information honestly doesn't inspire any confidence in me to return to trying to work on the WizDen docs repo, specifically because Jezithyr is still present as an individual who will (presumably) continue to shout down my efforts in getting nice user-facing documentation to the community in favour of her dedication to a shitty software that is bad and sucks big hairy nuts (im so sorry im trying to be professional but i fuuuucking hate outline and im losing the last few strands of my sanity having to think about the existence of that loathsome excuse of a solution)

I do sincerely appreciate Princess and the rest of the maintainer team I've interacted with for their continued engagement with my questions about documentation. I'm acutely aware that getting constantly reminded of an extant task when you have other commitments is very frustrating, especially when you cannot control the rate at which things happen in the pipeline. Princess and AugustSun have recommended that I apply for the DevOps team, which I might have done if I still felt I could tangibly contribute to WizDen docs (even if my knowledge of actual web infrastructure is laughable). But to be completely honest I'm personally at a point where I just don't feel like its worth trying to contribute to docs anymore. I'm out of energy and having to deal with all of this roundabout misinformation has genuinely nuked my passion for contributing.

It does not escape me that I am not the first individual who has in some way shape or form abandoned work on this project specifically due to misinformation spread by Jezithyr. I believe that Janet (sowelipililimute) also left the project due to the stress brought on by Delta-V's aborted rebase to MIT which was in tun caused by Jezithyr spreading panic about Steam licensing concerns (<https://discord.com/channels/1512897863099744296/1512898127693221918/1514594921691091105>) (<https://discord.com/channels/968983104247185448/976726219875831828/1539352878047830127>). **This is, to put it mildly, an alarming pattern.**

Jezithyr is a skilled developer. It is my current opinion that she is **completely unfit** for a leadership role as she has demonstrated a willingness to independently spread information about the state of a project without the knowledge or approval of those in positions of leadership concerning the aspects of the project she is actually talking about, to the detriment of staff and community alike, and doubled down when challenged on it.

Apologies if any parts of this follow-up statement come off as inflammatory or otherwise overly blunt. I'm very tired of dealing with this

statement ends

mqole: was also reached out to by an unrelated, anonymous individual who wished to share that they had messaged jezithyr to ask what happened due to being out of the loop. In the ensuing conversation, jezithyr shared confidential information with this individual, who was basically a stranger to her.

amatadorro: hive, will u talk today? bcs I've read in ur statement is this block: "she brings up adding revenue streams to wizden IE asking for royalties for servers that hit a certain size/profit threshold" And wanted to smon elaborate on it.

hive: jezithyr and veitableclaamity repeatedly brought up (during and after reorg) suggestion of policy where servers would be required to pay royalties to wizden at a certain size/profit threshold. hive pushed back on this a lot. Their justification was not thinking that any server would hit the threshold. hive: "why would you put a loaded gun on the table and then say it will never go off".

trosling: I will have to leave this because of an upcoming Imperium Maledictum session, but I would just like to say: I think it's very improper to not have a single representative of remaining WizDen here to speak, and the meeting should have been delayed until that could have been secured. We cannot possible leave this meeting with an informed opinion when we are getting only one side, and a bunch of screenshots that honestly don't show much, or are out of context, especially for people who are not super familiar with either side personally. I'm hoping maybe this will be addressed after I leave, but just wanted it said.

mqole: i did reach out to them, floor's open if anyone's around

hivehum: wizards' den was reached out to for a statement. they have not responded at this time

mazzie: I have already told Emissé that the meeting is ongoing and that their presence is requested and sent an invite. if they decide to join, they join

NOTE, per chief_engineer: There was apparently a miscommunication with someone else who personally declined to join but it was interpreted as being a stance from Wizden.

mqole: the following message was sent to cashew (acting community director) 3h before the meeting began:

message to cashew begins:

Apologies, i should have dmed this to you instead of sending it in a general discord where it might get lost! :p

I do want to bring to your attention something that I think is important to wizden's pr team. If you have not already been made aware, the SCC will be having an emergency meeting in 3 hours from now. As part of this, multiple former members of wizden (those who left today) have made clear their intention

to divulge experiences they have had working on wizden with Jezithyr, and share their reasonings for leaving the project. Jezithyr is in the SCC representing AfterLight, and is welcome to attend and/or speak, as are any other members of wizden who are in the SCC.

After the conclusion of the meeting, per SCC policy, a 24 hour period for members of the SCC to request retractions on the minutes will begin. After this time has elapsed the meeting minutes will be made public on GitHub for anyone to view. I'm giving you a courtesy heads-up about this so that Wizden has the opportunity to decide what actions they want to take if any from a PR perspective before those minutes are made public.

message ends

NOTE: The SCC meeting was announced in the SCC server 12 hours before the meeting began. At this time, server representatives in the SCC server were pinged about the meeting. Several members of WizDen, including Jezithyr, are members of the SCC.

PrincessCheeseballs - Former WizDen Communications Director

princess: Of the people who left princess was probably the closest to jezithyr. conflict completely destroyed friendship in effort to save the org. policy "must choose org over friends" not written for jezithyr but ended up applying to her.

jezithyr rejoined the project in May. things were fine-ish back then, the start of pattern that has been noticed continues, root thinning led to conflict. Any time an argument occurred, jezithyr would go into dms, princess would commiserate to try and help integrate jezithyr into the staff team. jezithyr paranoid about conflict, believing every conflict caused by people out to get her. princess would look into- could dismiss because he knew a lot of the people involved. would talk jezithyr down, get her to apologize- months long situation. princess swept this underlying problem under the rug, causing a lot of conflict.

fast forward, pjb leaves, auth back. reorg done very hastily at first (scc meeting about director stuff maybe?) left a lot of todos in policy, wanted to get things done fast. things stalled in june, one of the biggest holes in policy was maintainer policy. still has not been written. people willing to write it in june, staff manager team designed to connect all teams and communicate between departments. did not end up going through with it. lack of production. talks in June to establish production, notes written down. jezithyr asked to wait for her to write and review the policy herself. has still not happened. resulted in maintainer conflict, coscult cancelled.

2 big issues princess brings up to the director team. 1- conflicts, 2- what has jezithyr actually done these past months? She is very good at organizing design meetings. She is very talented. but through past months things has devolved, she has ignored policy, things have been swept under rug (partial princess culpability)

July no maintainer policy, slarti silently leaves project. around the time SM team first got jezithyr complaints. they piled up quickly due to leftover upstream hostility to pjb. was not able to be addressed until August. Janet also left- reasons more complex than just argument with

jezithyr. July issues now, Aug 18 first time issues brought up. Issues about AGPL. not about public channels- about argument in devops channel.

jezithyr very hostile to the devops team (post agpl lawyer letter, princess says it was worth it to have a definitive answer & comfortable position). jezithyr argued that wizden needed to take a hostile stance against AGPL, any risk being too much. A LOT of pushback - Delta-V exploded because of the first AGPL thing, following through on this would kill multiple downstreams even if it was something that was needed. bigger conflict ultimately jezithyrs conduct- threatened to leave the project, steam account blown up, but not what she said at time.

director meeting. conflicts with AGPL- twitch, console, options to leave open in future. agpl may no longer be tenable in future. Princess: fine with this so long as we can help downstreams recover- engine cutoff, years, whatever would potentially be needed. not a decision to be taken lightly. need to understand that wizden would be responsible for damage done to downstreams. felt jezithyr was not taking this seriously at all, effectively trying to force AGPL to be removed. so many layers. wanted to contact the lawyer again for another statement- princess gave contact info to someone else to do. This was never followed up on. dont think any money was spent, maybe they forgot. cannot understand stance taken internally and tactics taken to convince people to remove AGPL even discounting the letter received.

arguments would happen in channels with staff and then become director arguments. jezithyr would say bad faith things about people (bias against her) to dissuade- not to princess' knowledge manipulative tactics, believe that whatever happened with pjb has done irreparable damage to jezithyr that have resulted in her being unable to reasonably interact with the project in any meaningful way.

Princess did not sign an NDA, was apprehensive.

On aug 18 this complaint was sent to jezithyr privately, she took it very poorly. princess checked out here. jezithyr claimed the SM team was unreliable. At this time SM was getting so many complaints that they had to pile some together as part of the same incident. This was the time DR raised their staff complaint- princess asked that they get forwarded to SM, princess didnt handle but saw them. DR complaint in 2nd bundle, part of 2nd incident.

private group chat to discuss bridge. DR brought up concerns about jezithyr, princess willing to hear out. not willing to demote jezithyr. As complaints piled up, princess requested a staff complaint due to it becoming a conduct issue. staff complaint comes in, big fight in the director team, many found jezithyrs behaviour & pinning blame immature. immediately went to someone unrelated's dms and accused them of making a staff complaint.

joined a vc, princess joined to try and calm her down, jezithyr was going through it- "this is very stupid of them when i have full control of the steam page", statement made under a lot of stress and distress but raised concerns. princess heard this and told Reisama to immediately transfer the steam page.

2nd complaint came in, mediations attempted but fell through when dismissed by jezithyr, delays, things boiled over into September. many minor incidents between many people, don't remember the order.

Mazzie talked about the bridge incident- pretty accurate account. only adding afterwards jezithyr & princess talked in dms about it, a lot of same conduct (bias, vendetta), princess done with it due to mediations failing and promises not followed through on, conveyed to jezithyr that

she should respect the authority of PR team, community director has final say in bridge per policy. brought up not listening to mazzie (who emisse and princess backed up).

Every single time a director has overstepped and been called out on it, the director has backed off. jezithyr said she was game director and needed to communicate design. princess conveys PR never briefed on technical plans for mewbody, pr team a lot of cleaning up jezithyrs mess. ended by saying they would talk tomorrow, princess went to bed.

wake up, fight in pr channel with jezithyr- here where things started devolving. aus govt requiring age verification for 18+ games. jezithy publically spreads FUDD about it. pr politely tells jezithyr to shut up about it as no internal discussion has happened about it, not her decision to make, going to cause issues. The argument became "you have no authority to tell me what to do". dms: princess expresses very directly she is hugely overstepping. Things devolve further.

princess at time agreed to mediations with jezithyr that would have a 3rd party to attempt to resolve the singular issue with DR and jezithyr. litmus test to see if anything could be resolved or if it was a lost cause. very long multiple hours long mediation with jezithyr that if DR could apologize to jezithyr, she would apologize to them, she had to initiate. very specific concessions jezithyr promised - to respect the authority of the mod team, princess as authority. took hours to get her to agree. was ultimately "when i feel comfortable i'll give an apology async and you can apologize back". princess pushed back but ultimately conceded. hoped that even if async would open further discussions. An apology never happened. Mazzie went on break, debated leaving the project.

2 days later another argument- launcher update pushed, funny pjb announcement. devops said would look into it. jezithyr started an argument with the devops team demanding they do it a certain way, delaying time to resolve the issue. "This is a game director issue because the launcher is used to access the game"- denied, tech director absent, devops lead is in charge of this decision per policy- jezithyr declares self acting tech director due to Electro absence. This is specifically outlined as something that can never happen in policy, jezithyr immediately concedes. jezithyr brings in engine leads.

On this day (9/11) Kazne calls for jezithyr to be removed. princess asks for time to attempt mediations. jezithyr goes on break. directors agree, hope that she will take some time to reflect - understandable that jezithyr would lash out due to stress, willing to let her take as much time as she needs to reset and cool down from everything. When she comes back, jezithyr reaches out to princess, asked to wait for mediation for vote. told explicitly that removal from the project is a possibility, people may leave the project. aquif cited as correctly identifying organizational issues. long conversation between princess and jezithyr back and forth, at end, princess tells jezithyr he believes organizational failure alone cannot explain damage done in wizden. tells jezithyr she needs to step down. jezithyr understandably did not take this well, bringing it up as a director issue. A meeting was organized for it to happen a week from yesterday, delayed due to scheduling. reluctant to delay but kind of on a time crunch due to vote and impending exodus (devops team blocked or ignored jezithyr). This was when people started to communicate between each other about disagreements with jezithyr conduct.

princess identifies impending exodus, asks for vote to be expedited. requests DR not engage with jezithyr until meeting due to massive influx of complaints, public backtracking, not supplying information to downstreams about mewbody. jezithyr says in bridge she will not

support nobody (backtracking on previous statements), princess identified PR disaster, went into downstreams.

mazzie says it plans to leave, multiple people agree, "why are we waiting for the deadline we should leave now". princess rings the director alarm bell calling for an immediate vote, citing exodus as an emergency. vote to hold vote barely passes, permissions temp removed, a few days later vote ties, the result happens.

emphasis that directors are culpable in result of the situation as princess repeatedly informed them that this outcome would occur. Currently princess has no faith that jezithyr will competently lead this project. attitude towards the game team paranoid at best, hostile at worst. reiterating that she is incredibly talented, but not currently in a position to handle this responsibility. She is not a bad person, but the project is being harmed because of her fear to let go of it.

Additional Speakers

rosie: have brought this up- not a concern originally, now would like more elaboration on. mention of veritablecalamity and jezithyr asking downstreams for royalties. Can they do this?

geekyhobo: Yes

aquif: they could put it in the hub TOS but nothing else beyond that unless they were going to change the license of the code which they can do but that would only apply to new code

hivehum: imo, no. i don't think it would be a realistic thing to actually enforce. its a stupid policy that would exist to piss off a lot of people

rosie: is this likely to come up?

ress: Not in the immediate or near future

geeky: main concern held was that jezithyr was really pushing for monetization so she can get paid, unsure of the driving force behind there, push for wizden to be legitimate business. long time to implement, unsure if they have the talent at the moment. far off possibility. not against getting paid for peoples work - issue is that paying self with money that is there is not sustainable, unsure that jezithyr has the capability to back up her claims. unsure about veritablecalamity, knows he has played on downstreams, not sure about wizden

fan: I will add a context here that within the bridge VeritableCalamity stated that SS14 will not, nor ever will be, for profit within the bridge yesterday

rosie: concern somewhat alleviated- people not having the talent to do something does not mean they will not try, paying people for their work on wizden would be awesome (lizard plushies?) but framing of monetization is a concern.

geekyhobo: in past month jezithyr has spoken at least 4 times about doing what glitch productions does (making merch)

rosie: who is veritablecalamity?

geekyhobo: was brought in as a cybersecurity and legal expert by jezithyr, they are very close friends. was yelled at for pushing back on veritablecalamity being made director. reason for pushing back on this based on founding of robust LLC. veritablecalamity initial goal was for directors to be members of LLC. If directors are members of LLC, they are sole owners of LLC- would be each director having a vote, equal shares in the LLC. All directors would be sole

owners of LLC. worry about this random person showing up to effectively own SS14. veritablecalamity has not been very active. said during board meeting that he received 250 messages from downstreams, 10 of which related to jezithyr, rest positive. asked for it, received 21-page doc. will share doc.

rosie: watching discussions in bridge, impression got was that veritablecalamity became director a result in pjb split despite not having any prior involvement, and that veritablecalamity was making dismissive statements. felt untrustworthy. bringing to attention.

rosie: staff who have left wizden- under assumption they will not return unless very big changes happen. question to them- is there any intention of level for project continuance? 2nd time this year some sort of wizden split

mq: its on the docket

dave: was just appointed wizden acting director. may not have answers for all the questions that exist. was in favour of removing jezithyr. had seen many complaints coming through the pipeline as staff manager, tried many times to mediate or express concerns. currently speaking on behalf of self, not of wizden.

what is happening now? wizden is kind of on fire (nothing new). currently short 3 directors, have an acting community and ops director, have emisse electro veri and jez. trying to put together a proposal for arbitration between directors and those who have left to come to a solution. Would involve a neutral 3rd party. jezithyr is currently against it.

aquif shares a statement:

We cannot keep having walkouts every 3 months. That is not a healthy project. There are tonnes of open source projects that do not have these issues.

Additionally, I have been talking with some of our community members and their main complaint is that:

> The only way i can understand whats happening is to make my own ssl4 server, get it to be semi popular, then apply for a relations position
You should not need to be an ssl4 insider to understand what is going on with the base upstream

I think that the structure and culture of wizden is not conducive to having a good open source project. There is too much of a culture of secrecy. IMO all development should happen out in the open rather than in private staff channels like in other projects like GNOME and KDE. The public eye forces people to act in a reasonable manor and those who can't will be forced out due to being unreasonable.

There should not be a need for a private downstream bridge and in a well functioning project there would not be one. It should be a public channel for downstreams to discuss in with a private invite-only channel strictly reserved for security issues.

I think a particular case study of this is relating to having a documentation site to host governance info. Last night I asked if it was possible to get a copy of the bylaws of wizden. I was told that they intended to release it when the docs site went up which never happened. Meanwhile projects like codeburg just shove a markdown file in a git repo and call it a day rather than arguing what kind of documentation software will be used to host their governance info

From the outside it looks like Wizden also has a "too many managers" problem. There are too many leaders arguing and not enough people actually working on the project.

This issue of secrecy is a broader cultural issue and is not targeted at any specific person. In my opinion, the only private channels should be for finance and PD/Game Admin related discussions.

If people want to hear them I also have a number of ideas on how to structure a new central org for ssl4 but IDK what folks want to do. Based on what I have heard today I think wizden as a concept needs to be rebuilt from the ground up into a new entity.

statement ends

emogarbage via janet: who is going to be running the new engine?

aquif: i don't know we have decided on a new engine yet. I think a new engine is behind a discussion on if we want to hard fork in general

errant: Oh, the official engine? We still have Electro and Sloth, I think

Who has left the project, and what implications will this have?

List of every staff member that has left the project, unless someone has shadow left. Partially left - has left some roles, but not others. Some members of staff present to clarify status.

list provided by slam:

Fully left/Intend to leave:

Reisama

Kazne

PrincessCheeseballs

Mazzie

Hivehum

Boaz

Slam

AugustSun

Ed

ArtisticRoomba

Geeky (pending transfers)

Nem (pending finishing up PRs)

Scarky0 (pending end of month)

Partially left:

Ress

Scholar_nz

AJCM

SilentNiko

Errant

Considering fully leaving in the near future:

Maybe

Ada

Ress

Scholar

Admiral

Ledan/Slaughter

Nyx

Crude Oil

Errant

Minemoder

NOTE: this list was accurate at the time of the meeting, but is currently outdated.

geekyhobo: community team and staff managers are gone- this will affect bridge, anything PR related, basically all of devops is thinking about leaving. Infrastructure is probably going to suffer. Self fully leaving after moving keys.

ress: stepped down on pr, emergency ownly as headmin, on call for auth emergencies but will not make anything new. This is to ensure that the game can continue on and that destruction is minimal. This is the same for skar. not spoken to julian or simyon.

scar: going to leave pending the 30th of the month, deadline of NDA going into effect regarding PII. does not plan to sign it. may leave earlier if able to finish work on changeling.

Is there any potential for reparations?

errant: how many of these people would not come back if jezithyr left?

hivehum: i would not return until, at minimum, veritablecalamity also left

princess: Unknown but I doubt Kanze or Rei would

scar: i dont intend on coming back unless a 180 happens, jezi and veri are removed and the people i enjoyed working with throughout the years decide to return as well

janet: i don't intend on coming back unless the organizational shit that allowed jezithyr to get appointed and remain in place gets solved. A lot of the issues that incited me leaving were also at the smaller level like getting cockblocked on engine development and then people going "if only we had someone to work on \$THING_I_WAS_WORKING_ON" so even if the hypothetical leadership was overhauled i still would be kinda iffy on coming back unless i knew i wouldn't get caught on inane barriers

slam: I could consider returning if Jezi got the boot, with restructuring that is expected to follow. But it really depends.

mazzie: a ship of theseus style 'wizden only in name'. no jezithyr, no emisse, no veritablecalamity, no crazybrain, no rat, no sloth, unsure who else. generally the entire old guard + veritablecalamity. anyone complicit or supportive of this or has been around at a high level of the project long enough.

ress: In the end of the day, I upkeep the stuff that is required for everyone here, Not just WizDen. IF my duties were only kept within WizDen, I'd have left

FSP: If there is a 180 and things return to normalcy I will also step up this time and start bothering people

princess: similar position to kazne, if remaining directors all left and turned over keys it would be a 50/50. would only return if the PR team came back and concessions were made to ensure their needs would be met & directors stepped down. cannot think of wizden in a positive context anymore after such a genuine betrayal

janet shares a statement:

```
[context: i publicly disavowed offmed development]
[what's going on?]
i'm kinda disillusioned with the experiences i've had discussing anything
design w/ jezi and especially anything medical
i do this for as a hobby not for obligation so i'd rather just Not and move on
on that front
[anything you'd be willing to share for a staff complaint?]
from my vantage point i don't see how that'd result in anything of note
happening
[this will help us keep track of things]
i mean the most i'm willing to like write on the Staff Complaint side of things
is like:
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- a lot of my interactions with jezithyr leave me feeling like i'm being lectured to instead of being treated as an equal
- i don't feel like my work from pre-upheaval is being treated w/ respect when i have to correct on "that was a prototype, i wrote that it was a prototype, and i've told you that was a prototype, that thing was explicitly labelled as being smoke and mirrors and not a final product" multiple times and when i have to disambiguate the same thing multiple times
- i feel like my ideas are inherently less valued when i get something shut down harshly with "you need to justify that a lot more", and then seeing her propose a similar thing almost immediately after
 - or when i just get something outright refused flat and i don't feel like the perspective or concerns i have on why something shouldn't be taken as Ontologically Good are being heard

this is about as much effort as i'm willing to expend on this ^^

janet's statement ends

fan: observation that hardline is not just one person being removed, it's an overhaul of everything. How realistic is the condition being met?

princess: will probably never happen. wizden will probably become more insular and things will condense. asked if jez's proposal of reorg (removal of the PR team to be owned by the director collective, game director given near full control) was to go ahead, considers it a very bad idea. community director interim- cashew is great, please do not bully her, but she is not PR material at all. is a wonderful person but does not have the initiative or leadership to hold the position. if was promoted because of friendship with jezithyr, there will be a loss of faith in wizden as a whole. expect the project to slowly spiral and die. do not see concessions being made.

hivehum: ngl i dont think its gonna be slow. They lost most of the review team.

slam: I agree with Chzblz statement regarding Cashew. Cashew was a strong vocal supporter of Jezithyr in the vote meeting, and it was very appalling to see them being given the role they have considering they were yesterday a recently onboarded design developer.

What does this mean for downstreams?

Invite speakers from various downstreams to share what action they will take, if any

hivehum: wholly disavow wizden, advocate that downstreams cut ties and hard fork. would like to talk about the logistics of hard fork. Even aside from personal disagreements with jezithyr, leaving staff means a sharp drop in code quality, zero trust in remaining staff to maintain code.

mazzie: I will simply add I agree as former DSR

princess: I reluctantly agree but it hurts to say it

FSP: Hard fork was the action taken vs PJB. This is not a new decision.

mazzie: note that at this time in the meeting, Dave has formally resigned from wizden.

A lot of well wishes are expressed for Dave in chat.

lobster: considering a lot of this is happening behind closed doors it makes sense that the exodus is rolling as the info is disseminated

mq: part of intention with notifying wizden about SCC meeting was to subtly tell them they should say something publically fast because when minutes go live it will be bad for them (said completely neutrally)

janet: regarding stellar station (official sentiments):

- our plan even in the original governance dispute with PJB was always to move forwards w/ our thing at all costs. if we need to set up our own engine/hub and list it as a separate game on steam to get out, then we will.
- we're kinda in our own corner and the most important thing as far as we're concerned is that the engine maintenance and development continues
- we had plans to hardfork content wizden notwithstanding

regarding ephemeral space (unofficial sentiments):

- "it'd be nice if the shit we relied on didn't explode constantly explode"
 - (cough cough) engine
- we had already hardforked content and were doing our own thing for a lot of stuff, incl. ideally getting a steam listing/workshop support in the future
- as from emogarbage earlier, "ask them who is gonna be running the new engine"

both:

- the engine is the most important piece of the equation and our biggest stakes in it are continued maintenance/development
- engine fork is more on the table for stellar than it is for pheemy (but not wholly off the table for pheemy)

ress: regarding engine- looking at the list, only person left is sloth. never talked to the guy. expect the engine and content to slowly dwindle down until it stops appearing.

fsp: There are not a tonne of people who can manage engine and folks like me who can do would need a lot of time to upskill.

nairod: Sloth's extremely skilled and has put his head down to focus on nothing but the engine before, but he is still just one guy.

hivehum: i advocate for a hard fork of engine but it's one we would all have to agree on and be able to put our contributor bases toward

fan: will have to be a further discussion.

princess: I would like to say that relying on infra people staying because the game is held hostage as a result is not something we should rely on for stability

taydeo: last time we were able to set up a wizden mirror in about 48 hours. In the worst case scenario, we have the people to ensure things work. In the original discussion hard forking engine was a hard no. but wanted to hard fork engine with no single server and allow communities to grow around them. do think that if anything went down with a hard fork, macrocosm or other SCC servers would be the best to host infra or establish game direction. not ideal to host infra, but we do have a domain/email/framework set up.

personally very disappointed in the situation but everyone here has faith in maintaining the game. macrocosm has a meeting planned to discuss this and has a very clear no monetization policy.

princess: largely agree with tay. Downstreams have the ability to replace wizden vis a vis engine auth etc. was against this because during the pjb situation the team was there, still has faith in the staff that were around at wizden. A lot of positive messages about how good the reorg was, productive, moving quickly. scary as a project director that things moved so quickly that wasn't able to keep up with everything. saw what the reorg could have been, so so close to being fantastic. would have previously pushed back on what tay said, no longer have the staff team to point to. If there was any time for forks to consider seriously setting up their own thing, now is the time- there is no emergency or hostage situation, we are not pressed for time, but it should be something downstreams consider whether it be infra, engine, etc.

First staff complaints came from devops, has not gotten better, stepping on devops toes- does not trust stability of infra at all. will probably not immediately collapse but will eventually die or be woefully undermaintained (out for hours/days at a time).

tay: also wanted to see wizden succeed, believed in the vision. to avoid conflict of interest would personally be willing to resign on funky to maintain something for forks. macrocosm would also need to establish a separate org if we went that route. hope other people would agree, in favour of a vote for it in the future

emogabrage via janet: also happy to help on engine maintenance

fried: taken context of pjb situation, very disappointing that wizden was unable to overcome internal issues despite all the efforts made to do so. shortcomings demonstrate that if this could not happen after all the momentum with pjb, it could never happen, and the best option is to switch to a different org not plagued by the same problems. Advocating for hard fork towards something that is 1. widely established within the existing community, 2. rallied around by everyone (previous issue of possibly splintering) 3. not an inconvenience to players who want to play on multiple servers. The primary question of hard fork is how can we make this as easy as possible for the players. Even with previous auth situation players couldn't manage it easily, just wanna play the game. In the long run the technical hurdles are untenable. needs to be organized and unified whether macrocosm or something else.

vote proposal from aquif:

ALL INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS CAN VOTE INCLUDING UNAFFILIATED

Please take a few days to cool off and consider this before voting.

Do we think it is a good idea to form a separate organization to handle engine, authentication, and hub maintenance of SS14? If this vote succeeds we would start the process of organizing. This would be a separate organization independent from any fork.

This expires in two weeks.

proposal ends

fried: question about angel donor- is it possible to borrow to do a rebrand or anything?

princess: not really, is contact through a friend who is very busy. mostly relates to manufacturing. We do have a very good sell but it would be very unlikely to get an investor. would be no strings attached money for the org (the investors typically do it for tax writeoffs)

fan: core infrastructure should be divested between multiple servers to avoid risk of collapse. The website is very easy to change, steam page not so much. What's the future of the steam page?

geekyhobo: currently owned under the business account (just geeky), will be transferred back to them shortly

What does this mean for the SCC?

future meetings to potentially organize hard fork.

Vote on unaffiliated members?

- this will occur. Many people who wish to move to unaffiliated

Vote on WizDen members?

- This may depend on the results of the vote on hard fork.

aquif: My thoughts: If wizden does not nominate a rep we just remove them, If they do nominate a rep they can remain but they are not going to be treated any different from any other server

Final Questions & Notes

mq: minutes made public and recording unlisted per policy, period of 24 hours to request redactions or clarification. contested redactions will be voted on.

chief: I am still able to setup the unaffiliated devbus just as before need interest

hivehum: yeah you should do that LOL. i was only resistant because of bridge. but bridge is dead

chief: the main blockers have been people showing greater interest in bridge and a lack of moderator interest